FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-31-17001

Issue Title : Nuisance Momentary Illumination of Flight Data Recorder (FDR) "OFF" light and Master Caution Lights

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3131-00	-7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
03/07/2017	02/08/2019	02/08/2019
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	

Revision Description

The retrofit Boeing Service Bulletin 737-31-1801 Digital Flight Data Acquisition Unit (DFDAU) BlockPoint 1 (BP1) Software Update was released on November 29, 2018.

The Boeing Service Letter 737-SL-31-070 was released on February 7, 2019.

Applicability

737 MAX Airplanes below Line Number 7258 with Teledyne Digital Flight Data Acquisition Unit (DFDAU) Part Number (P/N) 2245000-101 and Honeywell Solid State Flight Data Recorder (SSFDR) P/N 980-4750-XXX.

Description

After the first engine is turned on, the Flight Data Recorder (FDR) “OFF” light, located at the Flight Recorder/Mach Airspeed Warning Test Module on the P5 Aft Overhead Panel, may illuminate briefly for less than 1 second, and then extinguish by itself. The Master Caution lights and the OVERHEAD caution annunciator also come on and off briefly at the same time. There is no associated aural alert nor maintenance message.

Based on observation from flight test airplanes, the occurrence rate is approximately once or twice per 100 flights.

The flashing of the lights has been determined to be a nuisance condition and is not applicable to 737 MAX airplanes equipped with the L-3 DFDR P/N 2100-4945-22.

There is no crew action required as the lights extinguish by themselves immediately.

There is no loss of function to the DFDAU or the FDR. Airplane data recording by either the DFDAU or the FDR is not interrupted. The airplane is fully operational.

Status

The root cause of the nuisance condition has been determined to be the DFDAU BITE in its interface with the Honeywell SSFDR P/N 980-4750-XXX.

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Boeing released Maintenance Tip (MT) 737 MT 31-016 and Flight Crew Operation Manual Bulletin (OMB) titled “Digital Flight Data Recorder (DFDR) amber OFF light illumination” to advise operators of this nuisance condition.

Boeing presented this issue at the March 2017 MAX Service Ready Conference.

Corrective action implemented in the DFDAU BlockPoint 1 (BP1).

The DFDAU BP1 software update is installed in production starting with Line Position 7258 (target).
The retrofit Boeing Service Bulletin 737-31-1801 was released on November 29, 2018.
The Boeing Service Letter 737-SL-31-070 was released on February 7, 2019.

Interim Action

There is no crew action required as the lights extinguish by themselves immediately.

There is no loss of function to the DFDAU or the FDR. Airplane data recording by either the DFDAU or the FDR is not interrupted. The airplane is fully operational.

Final Action

The DFDAU BP1 software update is installed in production starting with Line Position 7258.

More information on the DFDAU BP1 software update is available on the Boeing Service Letter 737-SL-31-070 released on February 7, 2019.
The retrofit Boeing Service Bulletin 737-31-1801 was released on November 29, 2018.

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

Root Cause Established: 29-JUN-17 (complete)

Solution Selected: 18-JAN-18 (complete)

Change Committed: 05-MAR-18 (complete)

Production Incorporation: Line Position 7258 (complete)

Service Bulletin 737-31-1801 Available: 29-NOV-18 (complete)

Parts Available: 29-NOV-2018 (complete)

Service Letter 737-SL-31-070 Available: 07-FEB-19 (complete)

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Service Bulletin (SB)	737-31-1801		11/29/2018
Maintenance Tip (MT)	MT 31-016		
Operations Manual Bulletin (OMB)	Digital Flight Data Recorder (DFDR) OFF light		

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Service Letter (SL)	737-SL-31-070		

Parts List

Part Name	Boeing Part Number	Supplier Name	Supplier Number
Digital Flight Data Acquisition Unit	2245000-101	Teledyne	2245000-101
Flight Data Recorder	2100-4945-22	L-3	2100-4945-22

Related Categories

- In Service Occurrences : null

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